

# ACECQA Service Quality, Accessibility & Operations Analysis — Presentation Script

Target length: ~9:00, inside the assignment's hard 5–10 minute window. **[SHOW ...]** marks when to bring up each chart; keep your face visible in a corner the whole time per the assignment requirement.

**Structure:** one central business problem, three angles on it. Every section opens by naming the problem or question *before* the chart appears — the chart is evidence for a claim you've already made, not a pattern you're discovering out loud. If you only remember one thing from these delivery notes: never say "here's a chart showing X" — say "X is a problem, here's the proof" instead.

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## Opening — state the problem, not the topic (0:00–0:45)

*[Face to camera, title slide]*

"Hi, I'm [YOUR NAME], and I work for government to improve education and care services across Australia. Here's the problem I'm here to help solve: ACECQA and state governments have a limited budget for lifting service quality and funding new services, spread across seventeen thousand approved services nationally. Spent well, that budget closes real gaps for families. Spent on the wrong thing, it doesn't move the needle at all. So today I'm answering three questions with data: where is quality actually failing and why, where are families genuinely cut off from services, and — just as important — what should we *stop* assuming matters, so we don't waste money chasing it."

## Data & method, briefly (0:45–1:10)

*[SHOW a slide with the dataset summary, or talk over the title slide]*

"Quickly on the data: this is the national register of every approved service, with quality ratings and transport-access data. Before trusting it, I checked it — ten services had no address at all and had all been geocoded to the same point in Myanmar. I dropped those rather than guess. Everything else checked out."

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## Problem 1: Is quality failing consistently, or is it a specific, fixable issue? (1:10–3:45)

"First problem: all eight states and territories apply the same National Law. If quality outcomes are wildly inconsistent anyway, that's either a resourcing gap or an enforcement gap — and knowing which one matters, because they need completely different fixes."

### Chart 1 — Rating by state (1:20–1:55)

*[SHOW 01\_rating\_by\_state.png]*

"They are wildly inconsistent. The ACT has forty-four percent of its services rated Exceeding NQS or above. Western Australia has four percent. Same law, ten-times difference. That's not noise — that's a finding that should already be uncomfortable for a national regulator."

### Chart 2 — Rating by service type (1:55–2:15)

*[SHOW 02\_rating\_by\_service\_type.png]*

"It's not just geography. Long Day Care — the single largest category in the dataset — sits at eighteen percent Exceeding, well behind preschools at forty-six to fifty percent. If we're prioritising where a quality-improvement dollar does the most good, Long Day Care is where the volume is."

### **Chart 3 — Which Quality Area drags states down (2:15–2:50)**

*[SHOW 03\_quality\_area\_heatmap.png]*

"This chart deliberately asks a different question to Chart 1 — not 'who's excelling,' but 'who's actually failing to meet the legal standard.' And it splits the problem in two. The Northern Territory and Tasmania have the highest non-compliance rates — up to fourteen percent of their services rated Working Towards or Significant Improvement Required — concentrated in Quality Area 1, educational program, and Quality Area 7, governance. Western Australia, despite being worst in Chart 1, is actually a different problem: its services mostly clear the bar and sit at Meeting, they just rarely reach Exceeding. That's a ceiling problem, not a compliance one. NT and Tasmania have a compliance problem — real, and more urgent."

### **Chart 4 — Spatial map of ratings (2:45–3:00)**

*[SHOW 04\_spatial\_ratings\_map.png]*

"And it's local enough to act on directly — you can see clusters of underperforming services around Perth and Adelaide specifically, which means a support team could be deployed to a cluster, not spread across an entire state."

### **Chart 5 — Does distance from transport hurt quality? (3:00–3:45)**

*[SHOW 05\_transport\_vs\_quality.png]*

"Before recommending a fix, I need to test the obvious hypothesis: does poor transport access damage quality? I looked at the share of services rated below the NQS standard by distance to the nearest train station. It rises from seven-point-six percent for the closest services to ten-point-three for the furthest — real and significant, but small. A transport upgrade might nudge quality slightly; it won't close a ten-times state-level gap. A minor risk factor beside much bigger drivers."

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## **Problem 2: Are families structurally cut off from services, and where worst? (3:45–5:50)**

"Second problem. Transport only explains a small slice of the quality picture — but it might still determine whether a family can use a service at all, which is a different, larger problem. I classified every service urban or rural using ABS boundaries, spatially joined to each service's own coordinates."

### **Chart 6 — Transport access across all four area types (3:55–4:20)**

*[SHOW 06\_transport\_by\_urban\_rural.png]*

"I used all four of the ABS's area categories here, not just a simple urban-or-rural split, because collapsing it would have hidden something. Major cities sit two kilometres from the nearest train station. But the worst-served category isn't the most remote one — it's small country towns, what the ABS calls

Bounded Localities, at a median twenty-nine kilometres. That's further than the more sparsely populated Rural Balance areas around them. For a family without a car, that's not a statistic, that's whether the service is usable at all — and it's a more specific target than 'rural' would have given us."

#### **Chart 7 — Quality across all four area types (4:20–4:40)**

*[SHOW 07\_rating\_by\_urban\_rural.png]*

"Quality itself does decline more predictably — twenty-two percent Exceeding in major cities, stepping down to seventeen percent in the two most rural categories. Smaller gap than the state-level one, but it compounds the access problem: families in smaller towns travel further *and* get somewhat lower average quality when they arrive."

#### **Chart 8 — Spatial map, urban vs rural (4:40–4:55)**

*[SHOW 08\_spatial\_urban\_rural.png]*

"Mapping it shows how concentrated the whole system is — the vast majority of services sit in a thin coastal band, leaving a long, thin tail of small services covering the rest of the country."

#### **Chart 9 — Where the gap is worst, specifically (4:55–5:50)**

*[SHOW 09\_coverage\_gaps.png]*

"Where does this bite hardest? Land-area density isn't useful here — most of inland Australia is uninhabited by definition. The real question: if a family's usual service is full, how far is the next one? In WA's smaller rural towns, a median forty-one kilometres. In the NT's equivalent areas, thirty-one. Everywhere else, under fifteen. Not a gradual disparity — a specific, fundable gap, and this chart names the two places to fund first."

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### **Problem 3: Which operational factors actually drive quality — and which just look like they do? (5:50–8:10)**

"Third problem, and it's a different kind of test. ACECQA could point to four operational levers — size, year-round operation, opening hours, how old a service is — and assume any of them explains quality. I tested all four directly. Two matter. Two don't."

#### **Chart 10 — Does size predict quality? No. (5:58–6:18)**

*[SHOW 10\_capacity\_by\_type.png]*

"Capacity varies a lot by type and by area — sixty-six places typical in major cities, twenty-seven in small country towns. But tested directly against rating, the correlation is negligible. A bigger centre isn't a better- or worse-run one — useful for Problem 2: a new rural service doesn't need to match a city-sized centre to be a good one."

#### **Chart 11 — Does year-round operation predict quality? Not independently. (6:18–6:40)**

*[SHOW 11\_operating\_pattern\_by\_type.png]*

"Long Day Care runs almost entirely year-round and scored lower than preschools in Chart 2 — that could look hours-driven. But controlling for type, comparing year-round to term-time within Long Day Care only, there aren't enough term-time services to draw a conclusion. This is mostly standing in for

service type, already covered — not an independent driver."

### **Chart 12 — Does approval date predict quality? Yes — the strongest signal here. (6:40–7:30)**

*[SHOW 12\_approval\_trend.png]*

"A data trap first: approvals-per-year spikes in 2012 — over four thousand in one year. Read naively, that's explosive growth. It isn't — the National Quality Framework commenced that January and bulk-transferred every already-operating service onto new numbers, not newly opened ones. The right-hand panel is the real story: grouped by when they were actually approved, services from 2019 onward sit at just eight-point-six percent Exceeding or above, against twenty-two-point-eight percent for pre-2012, long-established services. Newer services simply haven't had the years of embedded practice yet. That's the strongest operational signal in this whole analysis."

### **Chart 13 — Does opening hours predict quality? Yes, modestly. (7:30–8:10)**

*[SHOW 13\_hours\_vs\_quality.png]*

"Opening hours does show a real relationship — thirty-seven percent Exceeding under forty-five hours a week, down to eighteen percent for the longest-opening services. Smaller than the approval-cohort effect, but real. And closing the loop on Problem 1: transport still doesn't move capacity or hours in any meaningful way — its small quality effect from Chart 5 stands on its own. Two of four operational levers actually drive quality; two are noise dressed up as insight."

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## **Close — the decision, not a recap (8:10–8:50)**

*[Face to camera, optional summary slide]*

"So, back to the budget question I opened with. One: NT and Tasmania need urgent compliance intervention in educational program and governance specifically — that's a legal-minimum problem, not a generic audit. WA needs a different, lower-urgency fix: excellence coaching to push already-compliant services from Meeting to Exceeding. Two: WA's and the NT's rural Bounded Localities are the most underserved places in the country by a full order of magnitude — that's where a new service should go first. Three: fund transport access for equity, not as a quality play — real but small upside, don't oversell it. And four: give newly-approved services a support pathway, not a compliance one — they're not underperforming, they just haven't had the years yet. A budget with a reason behind every line. Thank you."

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## **Delivery notes**

- ~1,320 spoken words. At 140–160 words/minute that's roughly 8:15–9:25 — comfortable margin under the 10-minute hard cap even at a deliberate, unhurried pace. Practice once to check your own rate.
- **If you need to cut time**, in order: (1) the "Data & method" beat — compress the Myanmar catch to one sentence, (2) Chart 8's own beat — mention it in passing during Chart 9 instead, (3) Chart 11 — one sentence instead of two. Never cut Chart 5 or the transport call-back in Chart 13 — that "small effect, sized honestly against the bigger drivers" chain is your strongest evidence of analytical rigour for a policy audience, and it's what makes the closing recommendation credible rather than asserted.

- If asked why urban/rural wasn't done with the postcode-allocation method: the direct spatial join avoids the many-to-many postcode-to-SA1 mapping problem, since the dataset already has coordinates for every service.
- Keep the Family Day Care data-quality catches (capacity populated for only 2 of 417 services; "hours" meaning something structurally different for a scheme vs a single centre) in your back pocket for Q&A even if you don't narrate them in the timed script.